

honey bees are essential



USDA Does Critical Honey and Honey Bee Data Collection and Research

When bee populations collapse, farmers lose income and food prices rise.



The NASS Honey survey tracks how much honey is harvested, how many colonies are producing it, and at what price. Quarterly Honey Bee Colonies data reveals when bee colonies are failing. Cost of Pollination data shows what's at stake: 1.67 million acres of crops annually.



Scientists at USDA's Bee Research Laboratory (BRL at BARC) investigate and test solutions to problems flagged by National Agricultural Statistics Service (NASS) data (~28% production decline, increased colony losses, varroa mite spread).

